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GUIDES

Research Paper Title



TITLE



Rockefeller
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How to Improve Your Research Paper Title: 3 Basic Tips



Readers come across research paper titles in email alerts, social media posts, database searches, and reference sections of research papers and reviews. Based on the title, they deduce what a paper is about and whether it is relevant to them. Considering this, it is clear that the title of your paper is a strong determinant of how many people will invest time in reading it.

1 Keep it brief and simple.

The primary function of a title is to provide a precise summary of the paper's content and its essential conclusion—so keep the title brief and clear. Use active verbs instead of complex noun-based phrases, and avoid such punctuation as question marks, colons, and semicolons.

A good title for a research paper is typically around 10 to 12 words long. A lengthy

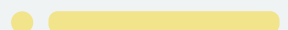
title may seem unfocused and take the readers' attention away from an important point.



Avoid: **Protein X has an effect on the migration of hippocampal and cerebellar neurons during the embryonic development of *Mus musculus***



Better: **Protein X promotes neuronal migration during mouse embryogenesis**



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2 Use appropriate descriptive words.

A good research paper title should contain keywords used in the manuscript and should define the nature of the study. Think about terms people would use to search for your study and include them in your title.



Avoid: **Mode of action of drug A on voltage-gated calcium channels: Comparative study of electrophysiological and structural data**



Better: **Drug A inhibits voltage-gated calcium channels by binding to lysine 114 in the intracellular gating loop**

3 Avoid abbreviations and jargon.

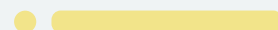
Standard abbreviations such as DNA, AIDS, and so on can be used in the title. However, other lesser-known or specific abbreviations and jargon that would not be immediately familiar to the readers should be left out.



Avoid: **MMP expression drives early stages of pancreatic cancer metastasis**



Better: **Matrix metalloproteinase expression drives early stages of pancreatic cancer metastasis**



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3-Point Checklist

- ☐ Does the title condense the paper's content in a few words?
- ☐ Would it capture my attention when skimming articles?
- ☐ Does it differentiate the paper from other papers of the same subject area?

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